

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1396

By Todd

A RESOLUTION commending trapping as an effective wildlife management tool.

WHEREAS, regulated trapping has long served as a vital and scientifically grounded tool for wildlife conservation and management, enabling state, federal, and tribal agencies to maintain balanced ecosystems, control predator populations, and protect critical habitats essential for biodiversity and species recovery; and

WHEREAS, trapping plays a pivotal role in furbearer management by protecting endangered and vulnerable species during key life-cycle stages, such as ground-nesting birds and sea turtles, while facilitating the successful reintroduction of populations such as river otter and beaver, thereby promoting healthy wildlife communities across diverse landscapes; and

WHEREAS, through targeted predator management, trapping significantly enhances waterfowl production in high-density breeding areas, where it reduces predation on duck eggs by species such as raccoons and skunks, boosting nest success rates from as low as 5 percent to 10 percent to the 15 percent to 20 percent threshold needed for stable populations and ultimately increasing duck numbers by tens of thousands and restoring natural breeding potential; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service recognizes trapping as an integral component of integrated pest management on national wildlife refuges, which is regulated under federal laws to sustainably manage wildlife populations, eradicate invasive species, control pests, and safeguard refuge infrastructure while ensuring compliance with state licensing and humane standards, including the trapping of feral wild pig populations that inflict \$2.5 billion in damage across thirty-five states; and

WHEREAS, according to the 2024 Association of Fish and Wildlife Agencies trapping survey, regulated private trapping subsidizes nuisance control, preventing escalated damage and avoiding higher expenses for taxpayers by saving, on average, \$16.5 million dollars; and

WHEREAS, trapping provides essential benefits, including disease control, economic value through fur harvesting, prevention of costly damage such as beaver-induced flooding, and effective population regulation of overabundant species to prevent the degradation of habitats supporting native wildlife recovery; and

WHEREAS, only abundant wildlife species are subject to regulated trapping seasons set by the Tennessee Fish and Wildlife Commission under scientifically based laws that monitor populations, while the Tennessee Wildlife Resources Agency provides education and licensing programs to foster ethical practices among participants; this regulatory structure reflects widespread public support for trapping as a responsible stewardship of natural resources; and

WHEREAS, according to the most recent data from the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, on the national level, trappers contribute \$884 million in Gross Domestic Product from related spending; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commend regulated trapping as an essential, humane, and effective component of modern wildlife management and conservation in Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we honor the education and outreach efforts that inform the public about the role of regulated trapping in balanced wildlife management and sustainable resource use.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we appreciate the contributions made by trappers to state wildlife management.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.